

ENGLISH GRAMMAR ASSESSMENT

Topics: Modals for Speculating & First Conditional Variations (120 Questions)

PART 1: Modals for Speculating (may, might, could, must)

SECTION A: MULTIPLE CHOICE

Choose the most appropriate modal verb based on the degree of certainty and context provided.

1. Look at those dark clouds! It _____ rain later, so take an umbrella just in case.
A) must
B) might
C) must not
2. John has been working for 14 hours straight. He _____ be absolutely exhausted.
A) could
B) may
C) must
3. "Where is Sarah?" – "I'm not sure. She _____ be in the library, or maybe she went home."
A) must
B) could
C) can't
4. That _____ be the famous actor! He looks completely different and much shorter in person.
A) might not
B) can't
C) must
5. I lost my keys. They _____ be in the car, but I've already checked the kitchen and they aren't there.
A) must
B) may
C) can't
6. The streets are completely wet. It _____ have rained heavily while we were inside.
A) could
B) must
C) might not

7. David has lived in Tokyo for fifteen years. He _____ speak Japanese fluently by now.
- A) must
 - B) may not
 - C) can't
8. "Whose jacket is this?" – "I'm not entirely sure. It _____ belong to Kevin, or maybe to Leo."
- A) must
 - B) might
 - C) can't
9. You haven't eaten anything since yesterday morning. You _____ be starving!
- A) could
 - B) may
 - C) must
10. "Is that the new teacher over there?" – "No, it _____ be him. The new teacher is much older and wears glasses."
- A) might not
 - B) can't
 - C) must
11. If you can't find your passport in your bag, check your drawer. It _____ be in there.
- A) must
 - B) could
 - C) can't
12. They have the exact same facial features and the same voice. They _____ be identical twins.
- A) might
 - B) must
 - C) could
13. "Why is the baby crying?" – "I don't know. He _____ be sleepy, or perhaps his stomach hurts."
- A) may
 - =B) must
 - C) can't
14. That story _____ be true! It sounds completely ridiculous and scientifically impossible.
- A) might not
 - B) can't
 - C) must

15. We _____ go to Spain for our vacation this summer, but we haven't booked any flights yet.

- A) must
- B) could
- C) can't

SECTION B: WORD ORDERING

Select the option that represents the correct grammatical sequence to form a logical sentence.

16. Order the words: be / the / true / story / must / .

- A) The must be true story.
- B) The story must be true.
- C) Must the story be true.

17. Order the words: not / they / come / might / party / the / to / .

- A) They might not come to the party.
- B) They not might come to the party.
- C) Might they not come to the party.

18. Order the words: could / answer / right / be / this / .

- A) This answer could right be.
- B) Could this answer be right.
- C) This answer could be right.

19. Order the words: at / home / she / must / now / be / .

- A) She must be at home now.
- B) Must she be at home now.
- C) At home she must be now.

20. Order the words: have / we / dynamic / could / a / problem / .

- A) We could have a problem.
- B) Could we have a problem.
- C) We have could a problem.

21. Order the words: be / keys / the / kitchen / might / in / your / .

- A) Your keys might be in the kitchen.
- B) Might your keys be in the kitchen.
- C) Your keys in the kitchen might be.

22. Order the words: not / answer / they / know / the / may / .

- A) They may not know the answer.
- B) They not may know the answer.
- C) May they not know the answer.

23. Order the words: dangerous / mountain / climbing / could / that / be / .

- A) That climbing mountain could be dangerous.
- B) Climbing that mountain could be dangerous.
- C) Could climbing that mountain be dangerous.

24. Order the words: tired / after / must / match / they / be / the / .

- A) They must be tired after the match.
- B) After the match they be must tired.
- C) Must they be tired after the match.

25. Order the words: wrong / package / be / this / must / the / .

- A) This package must be the wrong.
- B) This must be the wrong package.
- C) Must this package be the wrong.

26. Order the words: tonight / call / she / might / us / .

- A) She might call us tonight.
- B) Might she call us tonight.
- C) Tonight she call might us.

27. Order the words: expensive / restaurant / that / could / be / highly / .

- A) That restaurant could be highly expensive.
- B) Could that restaurant be highly expensive.
- C) That highly expensive restaurant could be.

28. Order the words: not / he / remember / details / might / the / .

- A) He might not remember the details.
- B) He not might remember the details.
- C) Might he not remember the details.

29. Order the words: traffic / heavy / be / must / the / now / .

- A) The traffic must be heavy now.
- B) Must the traffic be heavy now.
- C) Heavy the traffic must be now.

30. Order the words: solution / another / be / there / could / .

- A) Could there be another solution.
- B) There could be another solution.
- C) Another solution there could be.

SECTION C: ERROR IDENTIFICATION

Select the underlined option that contains a grammatical error or a logical contradiction.

31. She might (A) be (B) **at the office, but I am** not entirely sure (C).

- A) She might
- B) be
- C) not entirely sure

32. **He** must not (A) to be (B) **the boss; he doesn't have** the keys (C) **to the building.**

- A) must not
- B) to be
- C) the keys

33. **It** could (A) be (B) **a mistake, but we should** double-check (C).

- A) could
- B) be
- C) double-check

34. **You** must (A) **be hungry because you** just ate (B) **a huge** three-course meal (C). (*Contextual error*)

- A) must
- B) just ate
- C) three-course meal

35. **They** may not (A) knowing (B) **the truth yet because nobody** called them (C).

- A) may not
- B) knowing
- C) called them

36. **The performance** musts (A) be (B) **over by now because the lights** are turning on (C).

- A) musts
- B) be
- C) are turning on

37. **She** may not (A) to want (B) **to talk to us after** what happened (C).

- A) may not
- B) to want
- C) what happened

38. **They** coulds (A) arrive (B) **late because of the train** delay (C).

- A) coulds
- B) arrive
- C) delay

39. This can't (A) be the right house because the family living here has been (B) on vacation for a month (C). (Logical contradiction error)

- A) can't
- B) has been
- C) for a month

40. He might (A) be having (B) a meeting right now, so not call him (C).

- A) might
- B) be having
- C) not call him

41. You must not (A) to think (B) that learning a language is easy (C).

- A) must not
- B) to think
- C) is easy

42. The document could (A) contains (B) sensitive information, so keep it safe (C).

- A) could
- B) contains
- C) keep it safe

43. The children may (A) sleeping (B) upstairs, so please be quiet (C).

- A) may
- B) sleeping
- C) be quiet

44. That must (A) be the real diamond because it scratches (B) easily, and real diamonds never scratch (C). (Contextual deduction error)

- A) must
- B) scratches
- C) never scratch

45. We might not (A) having (B) enough time to visit the museum (C).

- A) might not
- B) having
- C) the museum

SECTION D: THEORETICAL REASONING & CONCEPT MATCHING

Select the correct choice that corresponds to standard grammatical rules and semantic interpretations.

46. Which modal verb expresses the highest degree of certainty that something is true based on evidence?

- A) Might
- B) Must
- C) Could

47. What is the main grammatical rule regarding the verb that follows a modal of speculation?

- A) It must be in the gerund form (-ing).
- B) It must be a base verb (infinitive without 'to').
- C) It must agree with the subject (add -s/-es).

48. If someone says "It may rain tomorrow," what is the speaker's level of certainty?

- A) 100% certain it will happen.
- B) 0% certain it will happen.
- C) Around 50% possibility.

49. Which of the following sentences uses a modal of speculation incorrectly according to context?

- A) "The lights are off. They must be home."
- B) "The lights are off. They might be asleep."
- C) "The lights are off. They could be out for dinner."

50. Choose the correct negative form used to speculate that something is logically impossible.

- A) Must not
- B) Can't
- C) Might not

51. Which modal verb represents a logical deduction that an event or state is impossible?

- A) Must not
- B) Can't
- C) Might not

52. What does the modal "could" imply when used for speculation in the present?

- A) Past ability only.
- B) A theoretical possibility based on conditions.
- C) Absolute certainty.

53. Identify the correct sentence structure for a negative speculation with weak possibility.

- A) Subject + can't + verb base.
- B) Subject + might not + verb base.
- C) Subject + must not + to + verb base.

54. Why is the sentence "He musts be a doctor" grammatically incorrect?

- A) Because "must" cannot be followed by "be".
- B) Because modal verbs never change form or add "-s" for the third person singular.
- C) Because "doctor" requires a past participle verb before it.

55. What is the communicative purpose of using modals like "may" or "might"?

- A) To state facts and absolute truths.
- B) To give strict orders and commands.
- C) To express degrees of uncertainty or hypothesis about a situation.

56. If you are 90% certain something is true based on strong evidence, which modal should you use?

- A) May
- B) Could
- C) Must

57. Which of the following options cannot be followed directly by a base verb?

- A) Might
- B) Ought
- C) Could

58. In speculative grammar, how do "may not" and "can't" differ?

- A) "May not" means it's possible it isn't true; "can't" means it is impossible to be true.
- B) "May not" is more certain than "can't".
- C) They mean exactly the same thing.

59. Choose the sentence that represents a purely logical deduction based on evidence.

- A) I might go to the beach if I feel like it.
- B) His car is not in the driveway, so he must be out.
- C) Can you open the window for me?

60. What happens to the meaning of "must" when used for speculation instead of obligation?

- A) It changes from a requirement imposed by authority to a strong logical conclusion.
- B) It means the exact same thing in both contexts.
- C) It refers exclusively to past events.

PART 2: First Conditional Variations (may, might, could, will probably)

SECTION A: MULTIPLE CHOICE

Choose the most grammatically correct option that completes the variant First Conditional sentence.

61. If you don't study for the exam, you _____ fail.

- A) will probably
- B) could probably
- C) probably will to

62. If we leave right now, we _____ catch the 5:00 PM train, but it's going to be tight.

- A) will definitely
- B) might
- C) wouldn't

63. If it rains this weekend, the match _____ be canceled, though the organizers haven't decided yet.

- A) may
- B) must
- C) will definitely

64. If she gets the job offer, she _____ accept it because the salary is very high.

- A) might not
- B) will probably
- C) could to

65. If you press this red button, the machine _____ stop working immediately.

- A) will probably
- B) might to
- C) could not

66. If you drink too much coffee before bed, you _____ sleep well.

- A) might not
- B) could to not
- C) will probably not to

67. If the company expands next year, they _____ hire more software engineers.

- A) could
- B) may to
- C) will probably

68. If he studies the vocabulary words every day, he _____ pass the test easily.
- A) will probably
 - B) might to
 - C) could probably to
69. If they miss the flight, they _____ have to reschedule the whole conference.
- A) may
 - B) must to
 - C) will definitely to
70. If she applies for the scholarship, she _____ get it, but competition is fierce.
- A) will definitely
 - B) might
 - C) wouldn't
71. If we don't protect the environment, global temperatures _____ rise significantly.
- A) will probably
 - B) may to
 - C) could to
72. If you buy this smartphone today, the store _____ give you a discount.
- A) might
 - B) could to
 - C) will probably to
73. If he practices his presentation, he _____ make fewer mistakes during the meeting.
- A) will probably
 - B) may not to
 - C) could to
74. If it snows heavily tonight, the school buses _____ run tomorrow morning.
- A) might not
 - B) won't probably
 - C) could not to
75. If you follow the instructions carefully, you _____ solve the puzzle in ten minutes.
- A) could
 - B) may to
 - C) will probably to

SECTION B: WORD ORDERING

Select the option that represents the correct grammatical sequence to form a logical conditional sentence.

76. Order the words: if / free / I / am / , / come / I / might / .

- A) If free I am, I might come.
- B) If I am free, I might come.
- C) I might come, if free I am.

77. Order the words: will / probably / they / stay / home / at / if / rains / it / .

- A) They will probably stay at home if it rains.
- B) If it rains they probably will stay at home.
- C) They probably stay will at home if it rains.

78. Order the words: we / lose / if / don't / hurry / could / we / the / train / .

- A) If we don't hurry, we could lose the train.
- B) We could lose the train if we hurry don't.
- C) If we don't hurry, could we lose the train.

79. Order the words: she / if / she / invites / me / , / go / may / .

- A) If she invites me, I may go.
- B) I may go if invites she me.
- C) If she me invites, I may go.

80. Order the words: will / she / if / passes / the / test / celebrate / probably / .

- A) She will probably celebrate if she passes the test.
- B) If she passes the test, probably she celebrate will.
- C) She probably will celebrate if passes she the test.

81. Order the words: if / works / hard / he / , / succeed / could / he / .

- A) If he works hard, he could succeed.
- B) He could succeed, if works hard he.
- C) If works hard he, he could succeed.

82. Order the words: will / probably / we / go / out / if / stops / raining / it / .

- A) We will probably go out if it stops raining.
- B) If it stops raining we probably will go out.
- C) We probably go will out if it stops raining.

83. Order the words: she / if / feels / sick / , / stay / home / may / at / .

- A) If she feels sick, she may stay at home.
- B) She may stay at home if feels sick she.
- C) If she sick feels, she may at home stay.

84. Order the words: if / price / drops / the / , / buy / I / might / it / .

- A) If the price drops, I might buy it.
- B) I might buy it if drops the price.
- C) If drops the price, I might buy it.

85. Order the words: they / lose / will / probably / the / match / if / don't / practice / they / .

- A) They will probably lose the match if they don't practice.
- B) If they don't practice they probably will lose the match.
- C) They probably lose will the match if they don't practice.

86. Order the words: if / you / help / me / , / finish / early / could / we / .

- A) If you help me, we could finish early.
- B) We could finish early if help me you.
- C) If you me help, could we finish early.

87. Order the words: the / event / may / cancel / they / if / cold / is / it / .

- A) They may cancel the event if it is cold.
- B) If it is cold they cancel the event may.
- C) They cancel the event may if it is cold.

88. Order the words: if / arrives / late / she / , / miss / the / intro / might / she / .

- A) If she arrives late, she might miss the intro.
- B) She might miss the intro if arrives late she.
- C) If arrives late she, she might miss the intro.

89. Order the words: will / probably / he / call / you / if / time / has / he / .

- A) He will probably call you if he has time.
- B) If he has time probably he will call you.
- C) He probably call will you if he has time.

90. Order the words: we / find / a / solution / if / talk / we / could / .

- A) We could find a solution if we talk.
- B) If we talk could we find a solution.
- C) We find a solution could if we talk.

SECTION C: ERROR IDENTIFICATION

Select the underlined option that contains a grammatical flaw or structural error.

91. If you will help (A) me, I might finish (B) the project by tonight (C).

- A) will help
- B) might finish
- C) by tonight

92. If he arrives (A) late, the manager probably will (B) be (C) angry.

- A) arrives
- B) probably will
- C) be

93. We could to go (A) **to the beach tomorrow** if the weather (B) improves (C).
A) could to go
B) if the weather
C) improves
94. If she doesn't practice (A), she may not passing (B) **her driving test** next week (C).
A) doesn't practice
B) may not passing
C) next week
95. If they save (A) **enough money**, they will probably buying (B) **a new car** (C).
A) save
B) will probably buying
C) car
96. If she will study (A) **every day**, she might pass (B) **the certification test** (C).
A) will study
B) might pass
C) test
97. If we don't leave (A) **now**, the train will probably leaving (B) without us (C).
A) don't leave
B) will probably leaving
C) without us
98. You could to get (A) **lost if you don't use** (B) **the map provided** (C).
A) could to get
B) don't use
C) provided
99. If they offering (A) **him the position**, he may accept (B) **it immediately** (C).
A) offering
B) may accept
C) immediately
100. If the weather is bad (A) **tomorrow**, we probably will (B) postpone (C) **the picnic**.
A) is bad
B) probably will
C) postpone
101. If you not add (A) **sugar**, the cake might taste (B) bitter (C).
A) not add
B) might taste
C) bitter

102. We may to go (A) to the museum if it opens (B) early (C).

- A) may to go
- B) opens
- C) early

103. If he drives (A) too fast, he coulds (B) cause (C) an accident.

- A) drives
- B) coulds
- C) cause

104. If they don't pay (A) the bill, the company will probably cuts (B) the service (C).

- A) don't pay
- B) will probably cuts
- C) the service

105. If you mix (A) blue and yellow, you will probably getting (B) green (C).

- A) mix
- B) will probably getting
- C) green

SECTION D: THEORETICAL REASONING & CONCEPT MATCHING

Select the option that matches grammatical paradigms and meaning interpretations.

106. In a First Conditional sentence, what tense is used in the "If-clause" (the condition)?

- A) Future Simple
- B) Present Simple
- C) Past Simple

107. What is the difference between using "will" and "might" in the result clause of a First Conditional?

- A) "Will" expresses a certain future outcome; "might" expresses a possible outcome.
- B) "Will" is used for the past; "might" is used for the future.
- C) There is no difference; they are completely interchangeable.

108. Where is the word "probably" correctly placed when used with "will" in an affirmative result clause?

- A) Before the word "will" (e.g., probably will go)
- B) After the word "will" (e.g., will probably go)
- C) At the very end of the sentence.

109. Which of these structures represents a valid variation of the First Conditional?

- A) If + Present Simple, Modal (may/might/could) + Verb base.
- B) If + Future Simple, Present Simple.
- C) If + Past Simple, Modal (may/might/could) + Verb base.

110. Read the sentence: "If I have time, I could help you." What does "could" mean in this context?

- A) An ability I had in the past.
- B) A definite promise to help.
- C) A possibility of helping in the future.

111. In the variation "If + Present Simple, may + base verb", what does "may" modify compared to "will"?

- A) It makes the result certain.
- B) It changes the result into a mere possibility instead of an absolute certainty.
- C) It shifts the tense to the past.

112. Which of the following sentences correctly displays the position of "probably" in a negative First Conditional result clause?

- A) He will probably not come if it rains.
- B) He probably will not come if it rains.
- C) Both A and B are grammatically acceptable positions.

113. Why can we NOT say "If it will rain, we might stay home"?

- A) Because "might" cannot be used with "stay".
- B) Because the "if-clause" in a standard first conditional cannot contain the future marker "will".
- C) Because "rain" must always be in the past tense.

114. What degree of certainty does the phrase "will probably" express?

- A) 100% absolute guarantee.
- B) High probability, but short of complete certainty (around 70-80%).
- C) Low, unlikely chance.

115. When using "could" in the result clause of a First Conditional, what are we implying?

- A) That the outcome is completely impossible.
- B) That the outcome is a possible ability or option in the future dependent on the condition.
- C) That the outcome happened yesterday.

116. Which structural element is entirely prohibited directly after modals like may, might, and could?

- A) The infinitive particle "to".
- B) The base form of a verb.
- C) Adverbs of frequency like "always".

117. What is the function of the "If-clause" in a conditional sentence?

- A) It states the definitive consequence.
- B) It establishes the prerequisite condition that must be met.
- C) It acts as the main subject of the sentence.

118. Identify the incorrect combination for a First Conditional variation.

- A) If + Present Simple, will probably + base verb.
- B) If + Present Simple, might + base verb.
- C) If + Future Simple, could + base verb.

119. What does changing "will" to "might not" in a conditional sentence do to the meaning?

- A) It converts a certain positive outcome into an uncertain negative outcome.
- B) It has no effect on the meaning.
- C) It makes the sentence a command.

120. In online automated grading, why is the sentence "If you work, you may to pass" marked wrong?

- A) Because "work" should be "works".
- B) Because modal verbs like "may" must never be followed by a "to-infinitive".
- C) Because the comma is missing.

Answer Key (Clave de Respuestas)

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	21	A	41	B	61	A	81	A	101	A
2	C	22	A	42	B	62	B	82	A	102	A
3	B	23	B	43	B	63	A	83	A	103	B
4	B	24	A	44	A	64	B	84	A	104	B
5	B	25	B	45	B	65	A	85	A	105	B
6	B	26	A	46	B	66	A	86	A	106	B
7	A	27	A	47	B	67	C	87	A	107	A
8	B	28	A	48	C	68	A	88	A	108	B
9	C	29	A	49	A	69	A	89	A	109	A
10	B	30	B	50	B	70	B	90	A	110	C
11	B	31	A	51	B	71	A	91	A	111	B
12	B	32	B	52	B	72	A	92	B	112	C
13	A	33	A	53	B	73	A	93	A	113	B
14	B	34	A	54	B	74	A	94	B	114	B
15	B	35	B	55	C	75	A	95	B	115	B
16	B	36	A	56	C	76	B	96	A	116	A
17	A	37	B	57	B	77	A	97	B	117	B
18	C	38	A	58	A	78	A	98	A	118	C
19	A	39	A	59	B	79	A	99	A	119	A
20	A	40	C	60	A	80	A	100	B	120	B